

Black Templars — 'Send Help' FIXED Runbook

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Mindset

Play it as a delivered-scalpel melee army, honest about its holes. The plan: bus a Sword Brethren spike into the enemy's biggest threat (Knight/vehicle/monster) and DELETE it in melee, hold the middle with the cover-fittable Grimaldus brick, and use the EC to assassinate a key character. Three disciplines: (1) PROTECT THE 2 BUSES — they're the only delivery; screen and use LoS, because if both die the spikes walk and the plan dies. (2) HIDE THE BRICKS IN COVER — run 10s, not a 20, so they actually fit. (3) DON'T expect the guns to bail you out — Marines shoot badly without Oath, so Oath the one thing you must shoot and win everything else in melee. Accept the hard matchups (castled shooting, Knights that stay back, true hordes, pure speed): pick your spike targets, grind primary, and don't throw a bus into open ground.

Weighted ~41%. The FIXED 'send help' list is a deliberately-hard Take-and-Hold brief: an underdog that lives on delivery landing + holding, and folds when the alpha is denied.

Tapestry quick-reference

Rule	What it does
The SPIKE — how BT does anti-tank (in melee)	Marshal (INSPIRATIONAL EXEMPLAR: unmodified Hit 5+ = Critical Hit) + Sword Brethren power weapons ([LETHAL HITS]: crit = auto-wound) = Lethal Hits on 5s. + Castellan (VEHEMENT AGGRESSION: re-roll Hits) + Slayers of Abominations (1CP: +2 S vs MONSTER/VEHICLE = S7). One Marshal+Castellan+5-Sword-Brethren spike ONE-SHOTS an Armiger and badly hurts a big Knight/vehicle — in the fight phase, where Knights have no invuln. This IS the army's anti-tank.
Delivery = the whole fix (2x Land Raider Crusader + jump reserve)	The spikes are M6 on foot and die on the walk unless bused — and per core 18.04 ONLY a Land Raider Crusader (ASSAULT RAMP) can drive up AND let the spike charge the same turn; a Repulsor forces a Rapid Disembark that FORBIDS charging. So both spikes ride Crusaders for a true one-turn alpha. A jump-pack Assault Intercessor RESERVE adds a delivery FLOOR (a threat even if a bus dies) + pressures a castled/kiting enemy — this lifts the delivery-race matchups (see VERSION HISTORY: T'au +4, Astra +10, Drukhari +5). RISK: still only 2 buses + a reserve, and dropping the Repulsors costs the Heavy Laser Destroyers, so ranged AT is thin (Lancer + Eradicators).
Oath of Moment (and BT's bad shooting)	Marines shoot BADLY without Oath. Oath (name 1 enemy unit -> army-wide re-roll Hits into it) is what makes the thin gun package (Gladiator Lancer + 6 Eradicators, the Land Raiders' hurricane bolters + assault cannons) do anything. Point it at the ONE big thing you must shoot; the rest of your killing is the delivered melee.
Companions of Vehemence —	Units make surge moves (~D6"); Crusader Squads via Righteous Zeal surge toward the CLOSEST OBJECTIVE when shot. It's the mobility patch for a slow foot army — but see the

surge (2 DP)	cover caveat: a surge onto an objective you can't fit into cover on just exposes the brick.
Marshal's Household — the Sword Brethren detachment (1 DP)	Friendly SWORD BROTHERS SQUAD units have +1 OC. Strats: Slayers of Abominations (+2 S vs Mon/Veh — the spike's anti-tank switch), Blade of Detestation (mortals on the charge), Unsparing Execution (punish fall-back). Enhancements: FERVENT EXEMPLARS (+1 charge, 10 — take this: it helps the spike CONNECT out of the transport) and INHERITORS OF SIGISMUND (Fights First, 15 — SKIP on a spike: per 12.04 charging already grants fights-first, so the ability only matters in ongoing combats a kill-and-leave scalpel avoids). Both are Sword-Brethren-SQUAD upgrades and DO count toward the 3-enhancement cap (the 'free enhancement' clause belongs to The Living Miracle detachment, not this one).
Grimaldus — the only Chaplain worth it	FNP + Litany on the Crusader anvil = the staying power a foot brick needs. Every OTHER BT Chaplain is a tax (the Execrator = 50 pts for Advance-and-Charge); this list runs Grimaldus and no other.
The 20-brick trap (why we run 10s)	GW's intended BT survivability is a 20-model Crusader brick + surge. On modern terrain-dense boards a 20-brick physically CANNOT FIT INSIDE COVER, so it eats shooting in the open and the surge just walks it into more fire. We run 10-model bricks that actually fit cover and screen — less sticky, far more survivable in practice.
Emperor's Champion — the scalpel	Black Sword S8 AP-3 D3 A6 [PRECISION] -> he alone can pick out and kill an attached enemy Character in melee (Sigismund's Heir even lets him re-roll a charge to reach a Character within 12"). Lone Operative until he joins a unit. Save him for the enemy's key buff-character.
What this list genuinely can't do	(1) REACH a castled gunline/Knight army that stays back — the AT is melee, the shooting is bad; (2) out-body a horde (Orks); (3) out-run a fast army that kites the spikes. Its whole game is 'get a spike into the thing that matters.' If the buses die or the enemy refuses the fight, it has few answers.

Per-matchup battle plans (10 archetypes)

Emperor's Children — 59% (Lean favourable) · you play **Immovable Object vs their **Purge the Foe (they play Unstoppable Force)****

Deciding factor: A melee brawl you're built to win the exchanges of: a delivered spike (S7 + Slayers) ONE-SHOTS a Defiler, Grimaldus FNP out-lasts the Infractor/Daemonette swarm, and the EC Precision-kills a Lord Exultant. Their AP-1/-2 volume is the wrong shape for your armour.

Plan:

- Bus a spike into a Defiler each turn (their only real anti-armour) and delete it in melee.
- Let the chaff crash the Grimaldus brick; it holds, and the 2nd spike counter-punches.
- EC hunts the buff character; grind primary — you out-durable and out-fight the paper swarm.

Watch: Fulgrim (Fights First) can kill a spike before it swings — Oath+shoot him or bait him onto the anvil first.

Orks — 30% (Unfavourable) · you play **Battlefield Dominance vs their **Take and Hold (they play Battlefield Dominance)****

Deciding factor: The spikes are wasted here — Slayers of Abominations only fires vs MONSTER/VEHICLE, so

vs 100 Boyz your S7 auto-wounds are killing 1-wound bodies with a sledgehammer. The horde out-bodies your 10-bricks and blankets the board; you can't clear 100.

Plan:

- Save the spikes for the Kill Rig/Stompa/Deffkillla (the only Mon/Veh targets); grind Boyz with the anvil + Assault Intercessors + gatling.
- Hold your two cover-bricks' objectives, concede the middle; race secondaries.
- Gladiator Lancer + Eradicators delete the Wazdakka/big wagons; don't over-commit a bus into the tide.

Watch: Getting out-actioned and out-bodied; and a Rokkit popping a bus. Honest ~30% — this is a bad matchup, minimise the margin.

Adeptus Mechanicus — 29% (Unfavourable) · you play **Inescapable Dominion** vs their Priority Assets (they play Secure Asset)

Deciding factor: A spike deletes a Kataphron brick in melee, and their D6-damage guns over-kill your bodies (waste) — BUT their shooting can pop your buses before you arrive. Whoever wins the delivery race wins: reach them and they fold; get the buses shot and you have no reach (BT's bad shooting can't crack a gunline).

Plan:

- Advance the buses behind terrain/screens — never park in open Kataphron/ferrumite LoS turn 1.
- Deliver both spikes into the gunline T2-3; it has few melee bodies and folds. Oath a Kataphron brick for the guns.
- Surge the anvil onto mid objectives; out-score once their shooting is tar-pitted in melee.

Watch: Both buses dying early = you can't reach them and can't out-shoot them = a loss. This matchup lives or dies on the buses surviving to deliver.

T'au Empire — 48% (Coin-flip) · you play **Immovable Object** vs their Purge the Foe (they play Unstoppable Force)

Deciding factor: The nightmare shape: a shooting alpha that one-shots Repulsors before you deliver, then kites your M6 spikes forever. Strand the buses and you have a melee army with nothing in range — and BT's own shooting can't punish T'au. You often just never get to fight.

Plan:

- MAX reserves + terrain T1-2; keep BOTH buses out of first-turn rail/fusion LoS at ALL costs.
- If you get a bus in, delete a Riptide/Crisis brick with a spike — T'au fold in melee IF you reach.
- If both buses die early, pivot to holding cover-bricks + secondaries and accept a grind; don't force stranded charges into the open.

Watch: This is a delivery race you're badly behind in, and your shooting can't bail you out. ~28% — your single worst archetype; don't spend CP on AoC vs their AP-4/-5 (it does nothing).

Necrons — 45% (Coin-flip) · you play **Battlefield Dominance** vs their Take and Hold (they play Battlefield Dominance)

Deciding factor: A spike badly hurts a C'tan in melee (S7 + Lethal auto-wounds partly beat the 4+/-1Dmg), but you can't table 3 shards and reanimation refunds the chip; gauss pops your buses. You out-fight Wraiths/Lychguard and the EC snipes a Technomancer.

Plan:

- Bus a spike into ONE C'tan and commit — chip spread just reanimates away.
- EC assassinates the Technomancer/Cryptek that fuels reanimation; hammers kill the escorts.
- Hold cover-bricks + surge; win on sticky primary, not on the body count.

Watch: Losing a bus to gauss + the C'tan grinding your midboard. A coin-flip you steal on objectives, not one you dominate.

Adeptus Custodes — 45% (Coin-flip) · you play **Battlefield Dominance** vs their Take and Hold (they play Battlefield Dominance)

Deciding factor: Elite melee mirror. Note the spike's +2 S is vs MONSTER/VEHICLE, so vs Custodian INFANTRY you're at S5 (still Lethal-on-5) — good but not a one-shot. Your edge is BODIES + the EC's PRECISION Black Sword to duel their characters, and a spike deletes a Caladius/Telemon.

Plan:

- Don't feed a lone spike into Wardens head-on — gang two units or shoot them with Oath.
- EMPEROR'S CHAMPION vs their Blade Champion/Trajann: Precision + Anti-Character = a real melee assassination.
- Out-body + out-score; a spike one-shots the Caladius; hold cover-bricks.

Watch: Their melee out-damages a single spike; commit together and let the EC take the character duel.

Blood Angels — 41% (Lean unfavourable) · you play **Battlefield Dominance** vs their Take and Hold (they play Battlefield Dominance)

Deciding factor: A faster melee army that gets the charge first: DC/Sang Guard M12 + Deep Strike out-deliver your 2 buses. You're durable enough to receive and counter-punch with a fresh spike, but you're behind on tempo and they can pop a bus on the drop.

Plan:

- Screen so DC/Sang Guard land 9"+ out; gatling + Assault Intercessor overwatch thins them.
- RECEIVE the charge on the Grimaldus brick, then counter-charge the spent unit with a fresh spike + EC on their Priest/Lemartes.
- Trade evenly, out-score late — they're fragile once the alpha is spent.

Watch: Both spikes getting charged before they swing; you want to receive here, not over-extend. Their delivery beats yours.

Dark Angels — 27% (Unfavourable) · you play **Inescapable Dominion** vs their Priority Assets (they play Secure Asset)

Deciding factor: A good matchup for the spike: the Deathwing 4++/-1Dmg mace brick shrugs normal power weapons, but LETHAL HITS auto-wounds skip the to-wound roll and the volume grinds even Terminators — and a delivered spike + Slayers isn't needed here (they're infantry) but the Lethal-on-5 volume still bites. Melee mirror decided on primary.

Plan:

- Deliver a spike into the Deathwing brick — Lethal Hits on 5s out-grinds the 4++ better than shooting does.
- EC + 2nd spike hunt the softer support / characters; the Lion is a Monster -> a spike + Slayers (S7) or the Lancer.
- Race objectives; both armies are slow, so cover-bricks + surge decide it.

Watch: Feeding one spike piecemeal into the mace brick; commit with support. Even, decided on primary.

Drukhari — 47% (Coin-flip) · you play **Purge and Secure** vs their **Reconnaissance (they play Reconnaissance Sweep)**

Deciding factor: Speed kills you: they out-manoeuver M6, kite the spikes, dark-lance the Repulsors, and flip objectives late. Your armour tanks the splinter, but you can't CATCH them and your shooting can't punish their paper at range.

Plan:

- Hold a tight castle + cover-bricks; make them commit into your bubble (their paper folds if it does).
- Gladiator Lancer + Eradicators + Oath one-shot Ravagers/Venoms to cut their mobility and the lance threat to the buses.
- Zone with screens so they can't backfield-raid; grind the secondaries you can hold.

Watch: Out-actioned by raw speed while the spikes chase air; protect the buses from lances. ~35%.

Astra Militarum — 28% (Unfavourable) · you play **Inescapable Dominion** vs their **Priority Assets (they play Secure Asset)**

Deciding factor: Their tanks are PRIME spike food — Slayers (+2 S, S7) + Lethal Hits one-shots a Russ and badly hurts a Shadowsword in melee — and their guns over-kill your bodies (waste). But their volume CAN pop a bus, so it's a delivery race again.

Plan:

- Advance behind terrain; deliver a spike into a superheavy/Russ each turn and delete it in the fight.
- Assault Intercessors + anvil carve the Guard infantry; surge onto objectives their tanks can't hold.
- Gladiator Lancer + Eradicators tax anything the spikes can't reach; out-score a low-model tank list.

Watch: Artillery + orders chip the buses before you connect; screen them to the first melee. Slight favour if you weather T1-2.

The list

Unit	×	Role / wargear	Pts
Land Raider Crusader (Spike A bus)	1	ASSAULT RAMP: drive up + disembark + the spike STILL CHARGES this turn (core 18.04: a Repulsor CANNOT — Rapid Disembark forbids charging). T12/W16/2+, cap 16. This is why BT delivers in Land Raiders, not Repulsors.	220
Marshal + Oathbound Exemplar	1	WARLORD; leads Spike A's Sword Brethren. INSPIRATIONAL EXEMPLAR: unmodified Hit of 5+ = Critical Hit -> the whole reason the spike works.	95*
Castellan (Support)	1	Stacks into Spike A. VEHEMENT AGGRESSION: re-roll Hits (on a Ld pass) -> more 5+ crits to convert via Lethal Hits.	70
Sword Brethren Squad (Spike A)	5	Master-crafted power weapon S5 AP-2 D2 A3 [LETHAL HITS] -> with crit-on-5 + re-rolls + Slayers of Abominations (+2 S vs Mon/Veh = S7), ONE-SHOTS an Armiger. -> Land Raider Crusader A.	105
Land Raider	1	2nd ASSAULT RAMP bus -> Spike B also alpha-charges in one turn. Hurricane	220

Crusader (Spike B bus)		bolters + assault cannon add anti-infantry (helps the horde a little).	
Marshal (Spike B)	1	2nd crit-on-5 enabler; leads Spike B's Sword Brethren.	80*
Castellan (Support)	1	2nd re-roll enabler; stacks into Spike B.	70
Sword Brethren Squad (Spike B)	5	The 2nd delivered anti-tank spike. -> Land Raider Crusader.	105
Chaplain Grimaldus (+3 Cenobyte)	1	The ONLY good BT Chaplain. FNP + Litany -> the durability that lets a foot brick hold. Leads the Crusader anvil.	100*
Crusader Squad (Grimaldus anvil)	1 0	A 10-model brick that FITS COVER (the whole point — a 20-brick can't hide on modern boards). Sticky OC + Righteous Zeal surge.	150
Emperor's Champion	1	Duelist / character-assassin: Black Sword S8 AP-3 D3 A6 [ANTI-CHARACTER 5+, PRECISION]. Leads the 2nd Crusader brick (the jump Intercessors run solo from reserve).	75*
Crusader Squad (2nd cover-brick)	1 0	2nd cover-fittable objective holder + surge. EC or a Castellan can lead it.	150
Assault Intercessors w/ Jump Packs	1 0	The RESERVE/SPEED THREAT (v2): deep-strike + Rapid Ingress -> pressures a castled T'au/AdMech backfield and catches kiting Drukharis — a threat that DOESN'T need a bus. Fixes the two 'can't reach you' matchups.	160
Gladiator Lancer	1	The ONE efficient Oath-boosted RANGED AT: twin lascannon-class gun to reach the un-chargeable (a melee army's only long answer to castled armour).	160
Eradicator Squad	6	Melta AT backup (BT shooting is thin — this is a concession, not a gunline). Deep-strike/reposition threat.	180